recording devices, such as dictaphone, answering machines, live broadcasting and telecasting and video conferencing have nowadays, shifted the focus from writing to speaking.

7.12 Definition

"Communication is an intercourse by words, letters, symbols or messages and is a way that one organisation member shares meaning and understanding with another"

- Koontz and o Donnell.

"Communication is the exchange of facts, ideas, opinions or emotions by two or more persons"

- Newman and summer.



Figure 7.7 Business Communication

7.13 Characteristics of Communication

- There must be some message to be sent.
- There must be some purpose for communication.
- It involves more than two persons.
- It deals with transmission of facts and feeling of two persons.
- Transmission of every message is sent through a channel.
- Media or transmission of communication are numerous.
- Communication is a continuous process.
- Channels in communication are systematic and predetermined.
- It is a process of telling, listening and understanding.

7.14 Purpose of Communication

No organisation can function without proper and adequate communication. The ability to communicate effectively with other members of the organisation is considered as one of the most important skills of managers .

1. **Flow of information:**

   The relevant information must flow continuously from top to bottom and vice versa. The staff at all levels must be kept informed about the organisational objectives and other developments taking place in the organisation. The information can be passed in the language which the employees can understand better.

2. **Co-ordination:**

   It is through communication the efforts of all the staff working in the organization can be coordinated for the accomplishment of the organisational goals. The communication facilitates flow of information, ideas, beliefs, perception, advice, opinion, orders and instructions etc., both ways which enable the managers and other supervisory staff to learn managerial skills through the experience of others.

3. **Preparing people to Accept change:**

   The proper and effective communication is an important tool in the hands of management of any organisation to bring about overall change in the

XII OSS_English version CHAPTER 07.indd 89 1/7/2020 6:03:14 PM